

Trading Accounts and Simulation

Getting Started | beginner | 10 min to complete | DeepCharts Help Center | July 15, 2026

By the end you will have a simulation account with a starting balance you chose, and a trading panel set up to trade it.

DeepCharts includes a built-in **SIM** broker that fills your orders against the market data on your charts without risking real money. You only need a data feed for prices — no broker account is required to practice. This is the safest way to learn the order tools, and it is also how traders test strategies before going live.

Before you start

- DeepCharts installed and activated — [How to Install DeepCharts and Activate Your License](#)
- A data feed connected — [How to Connect a Data Feed \(Feed Settings\)](#) or the free 15-minute delayed feed
- A chart open — [Open Your First Chart](#)

Steps

Create or manage a simulation account

1. Click **Options** → **Settings** in the main bar. The **General Settings** window opens.
2. Select the **Sim Account** tab. Existing simulation accounts are listed with their **Name** and **Balance**.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The General Settings window on the Sim Account tab showing the accounts table with Name and Balance columns, a SIM account row, the per-row trash icon and the Add button

general-settings-sim-account-tab.png

3. Click **Add**. In the **Add Sim Account** dialog enter a **Name** and a starting **Balance** (default 10000), then click **Add**.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Add Sim Account dialog with the Name field filled in and the Balance field showing the default 10000, Cancel and Add buttons visible

add-sim-account-dialog.png

4. Click **Save Settings** at the bottom of the window.

Note: You can create multiple simulation accounts — for example one per strategy you are testing. The balance currency follows your Windows region setting, which is why some users see Rs, € or \$ on the same default number.

If you want to delete a simulation account

Click the trash icon on the account's row, then **Save Settings**.

Warning: Deleting a simulation account removes it from the trading panel's account list. **[CONFIRM: whether a deleted sim account's trade history remains available in Signal Performance / reports]**

Trade with a simulation account

1. On an open chart, enable the **Trading panel** toggle in the chart's bottom bar. The trading panel opens on the right side of the chart. (You can also right-click the chart and choose **Show Trading Panel**.)

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] A price chart with the bottom-bar Trading panel toggle highlighted and the trading panel open on the right side

chart-trading-panel-toggle.png

2. In the trading panel, set **Broker** to **SIM**.
3. Pick your simulation account in the **Account** dropdown.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The trading panel with Broker set to SIM and the Account dropdown open showing the created simulation accounts `trading-panel-broker-sim.png`

4. Place a test order — for example set the quantity to 1 and click **BUY MKT**. Trading from the Chart walks through every order type.

If you want to start over with a fresh balance

Add a new simulation account and switch the trading panel to it, or delete and re-create the old one.

[**CONFIRM: whether an existing sim account's balance can be reset directly without re-creating it**]

Switching to a real broker account

When you have credentials from a broker or prop firm, the same connection that delivers your market data also carries your orders:

1. Create the feed connection with your broker credentials — How to Connect a Data Feed (Feed Settings).
2. Check in **Options** → **Symbol Manage** that your exchanges are mapped to that connection — Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed.
3. Connect, open a chart, and open the trading panel.
4. Set **Broker** to your broker connection and pick the account.

Everything else in the panel works exactly as it does on SIM — see Trading Panel Reference: Every Button and Field for every field.

Verify it worked

With **Broker** = SIM and your account selected, place a one-contract market order: **Open Qty** changes to 1 and **Open P/L** starts ticking with the market. The order also appears in the Orders Window. Close the position with **Cancel** and **Flat** when you are done.

If something went wrong

Symptom	What to do
Account dropdown is empty	The account was not saved — re-add it in Options → Settings → Sim Account and click Save Settings
No trading panel on the chart	Enable the Trading panel toggle in the chart's bottom bar
Orders placed but nothing fills / price frozen	The chart has no moving data — Fix: Live Feed Connected but Chart Is Not Moving
Balance shows an unexpected currency symbol	The currency follows your Windows region setting — cosmetic only

Related articles

- Trading from the Chart
- Trading Panel Reference: Every Button and Field
- Orders Window
- Portfolio (Wallet)
- Risk Manager
- Quick Start: From Install to Your First Trade